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React Render HTML

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React's goal is in many ways to render HTML in a web page.

React renders HTML to the web page via a container, and a function called `createRoot()`.

The Container

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React uses a container to render HTML in a web page.

Typically, this container is a `<div id="root"></div>` element in the `index.html` file.

If you have followed the steps in the previous chapter, you should have a file called `index.html` in the root directory of your project:

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```
<!doctype html>
<html lang="en">
  <head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8" />
    <link rel="icon" type="image/svg+xml" href="/favicon.svg" />
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0" /
    <title>my-react-app</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <div id="root"></div>
    <script type="module" src="/src/main.jsx"></script>
  </body>
</html>
```

To better understand the content of the `index.html` file, let's remove all the code we don't need.

Example

The `index.html` file should now look like this:

index.html

```
<!doctype html>
<html lang="en">
  <body>
    <div id="root"></div>
    <script type="module" src="/src/main.jsx"></script>
  </body>
</html>
```

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The createRoot Function

The `createRoot` function is located in the `main.jsx` file in the `src` folder, and is a built-in function that is used to create a root node for a React application.

Example

The default content of the `src/main.jsx` file:

main.jsx

```
import { StrictMode } from 'react'
import { createRoot } from 'react-dom/client'
import './index.css'
import App from './App.jsx'

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <StrictMode>
    <App />
  </StrictMode>
)
```

The `createRoot()` function takes one argument, an HTML element.

The purpose of the function is to define the HTML element where a React component should be displayed.

To better understand the `createRoot` function, let's remove unnecessary code and write our own "Hello React!" example:

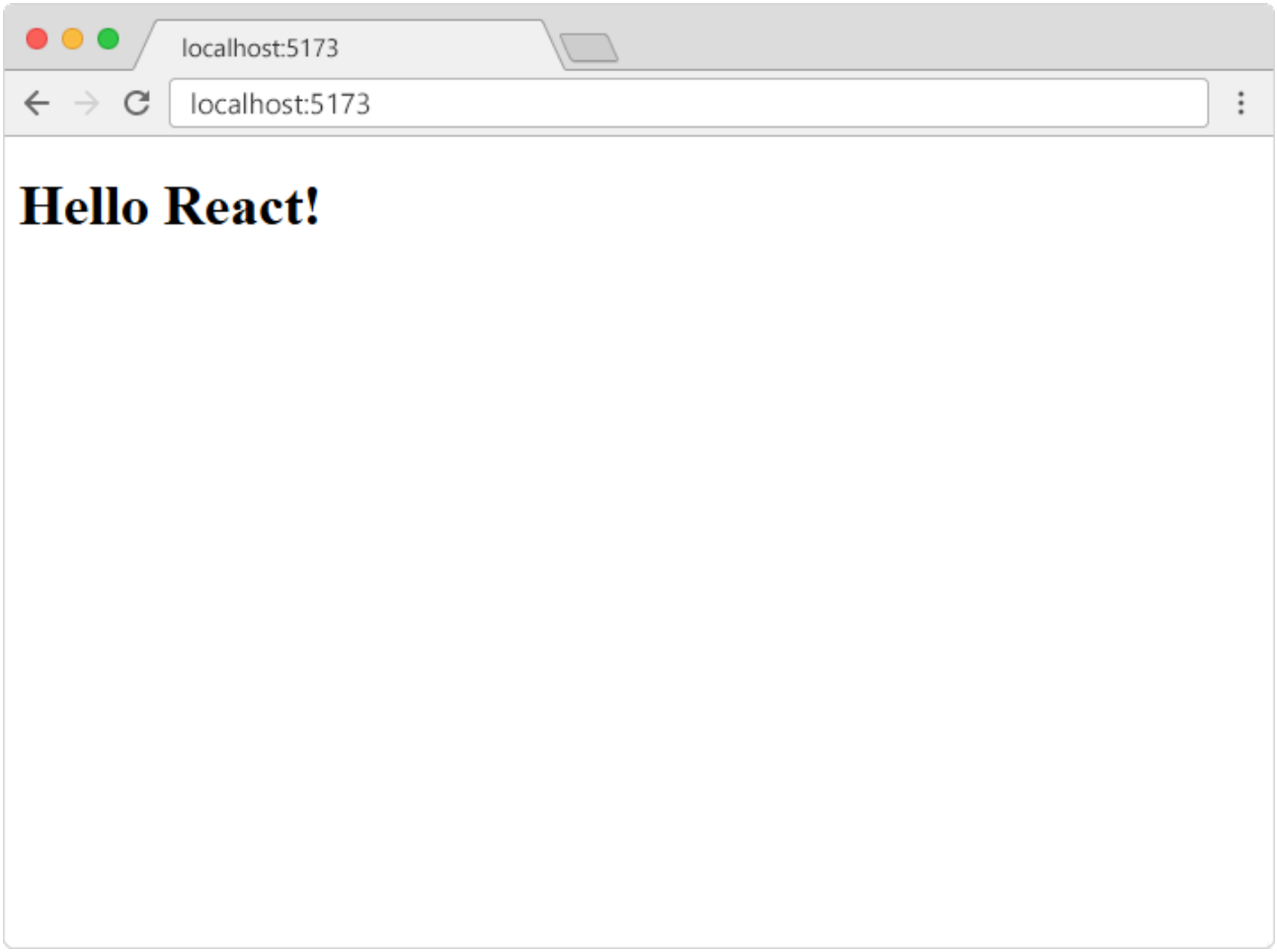
Example

The `src/main.jsx` file should now look like this:

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```
createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <h1>Hello React!</h1>
)
```

If you save the file, the result in the browser will look like this:



The render Method

Did you notice the `render` method?

The `render` method defines what to render in the HTML container.

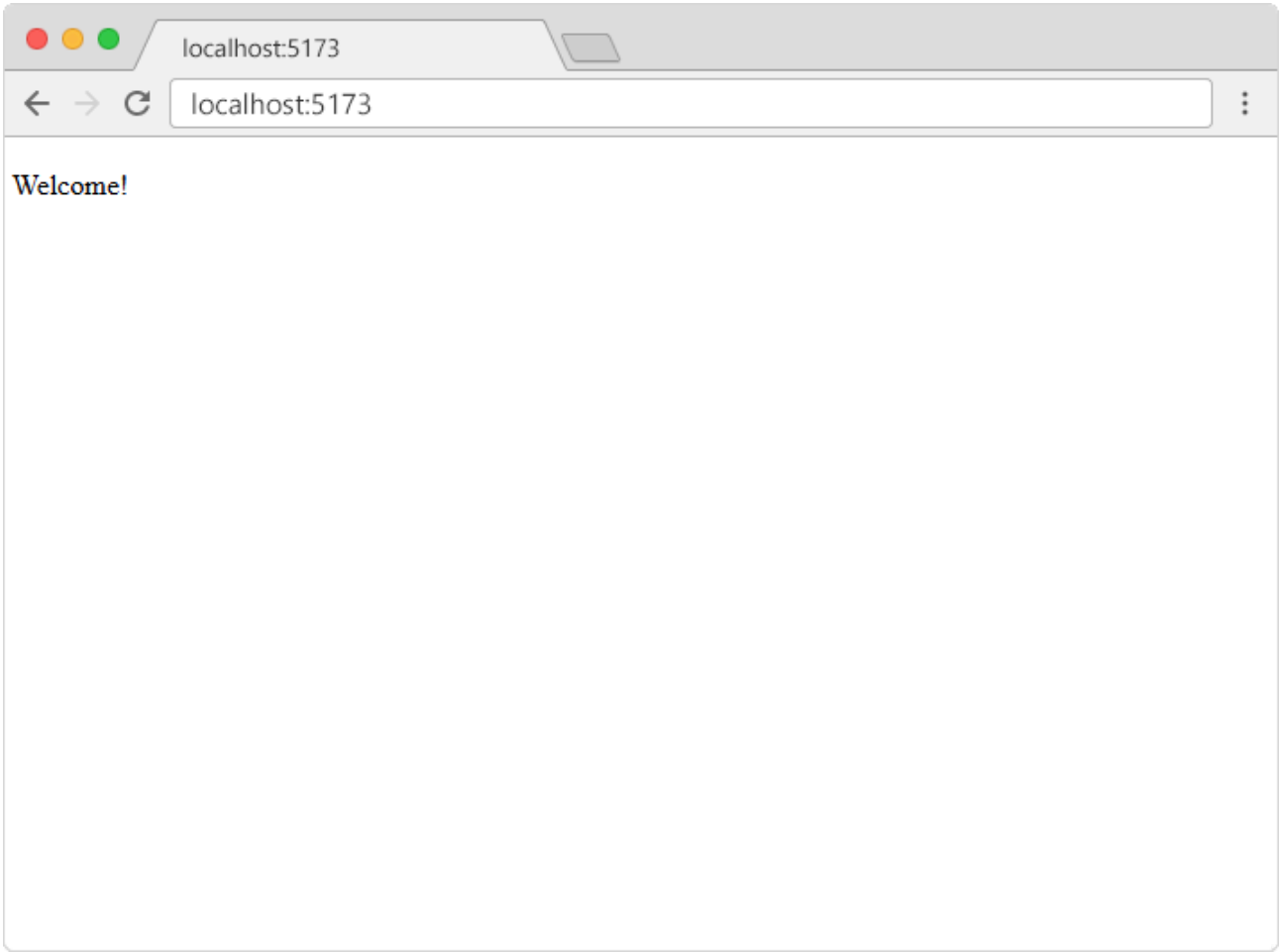
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main.jsx

```
import { createRoot } from 'react-dom/client'

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <p>Welcome!</p>
)
```

The result will look like this:



Note: the element id does not have to be "root", but this is the standard convention.

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REMOVE ADS

Show React

W3Schools has its own "Show React" tool where we will show the result of the code we explain in the tutorial.

Click the "Run Example" button to see the result:

Example

The same example shown in our "Show React" tool:

main.jsx

```
import { createRoot } from 'react-dom/client'

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <p>Welcome!</p>
)
```

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The HTML Code

The HTML code in this tutorial uses JSX which allows you to write HTML tags inside the JavaScript code:

Don't worry if the syntax is unfamiliar, you will learn more about JSX later in this tutorial.

Example

Create a variable that contains HTML code and display it in the "root" node:

main.jsx

```
import { createRoot } from 'react-dom/client'

const myelement = (
  <table>
    <tr>
      <th>Name</th>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>John</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>Elsa</td>
    </tr>
  </table>
);

createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  myelement
)
```

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The Root Node

The root node is the HTML element where you want to display the result.

It is like a *container* for content, managed by React.

It does NOT have to be a `<div>` element and it does NOT have to have the `id='root'`:

Example

The root node can be called whatever you like.

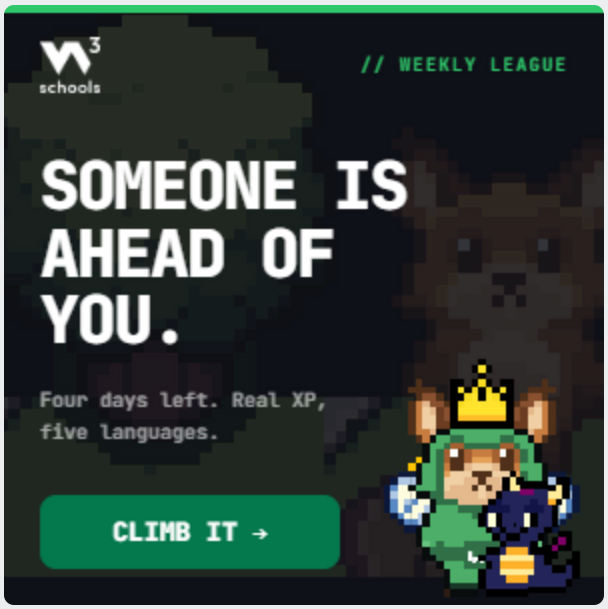
Display the result in the `<header id="sandy">` element:

index.html main.jsx

```
<!doctype html>
<html lang="en">
  <body>
    <header id="sandy"></header>
    <script type="module" src="/src/main.jsx"></script>
  </body>
</html>
```

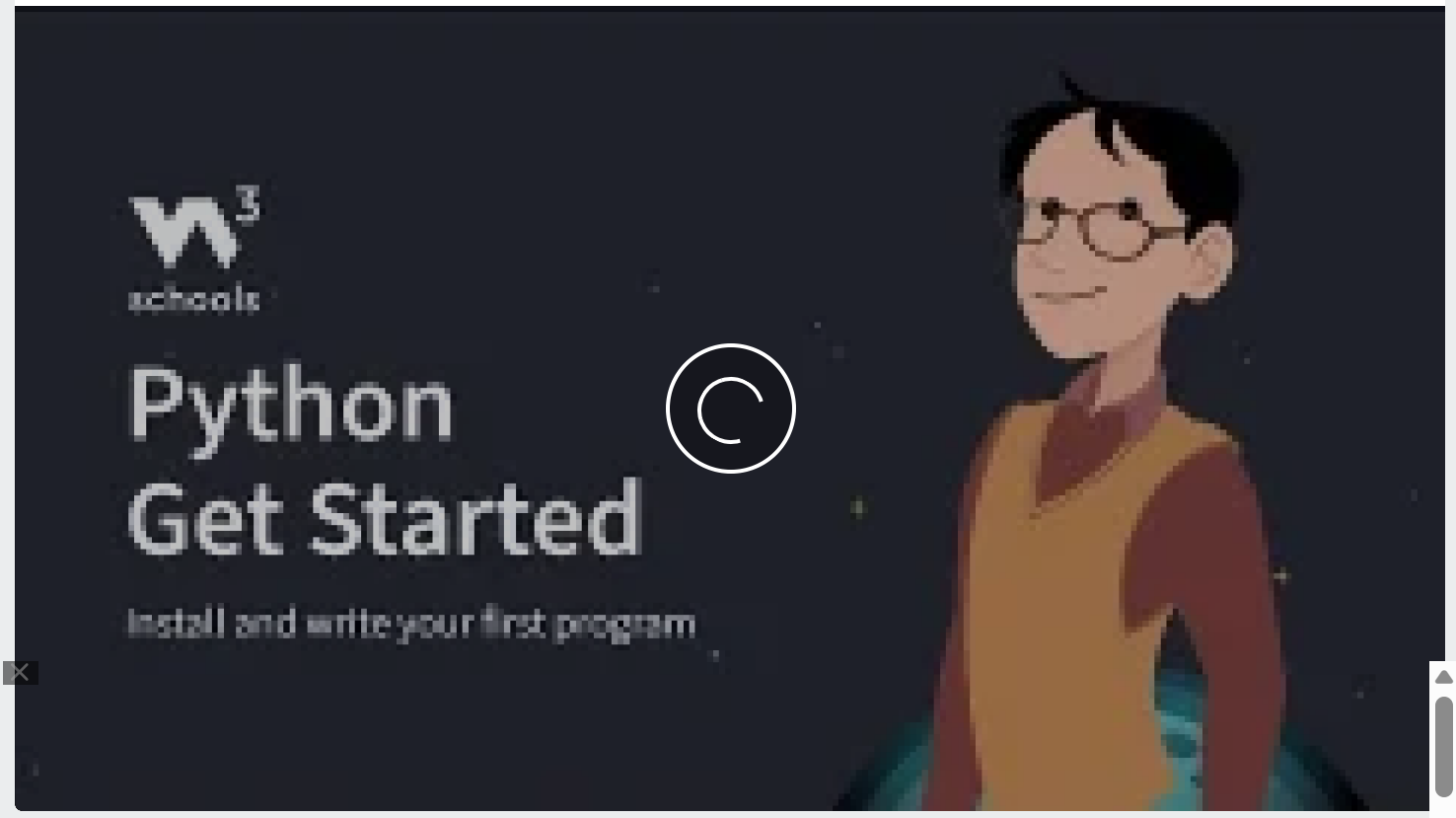
Run Example »

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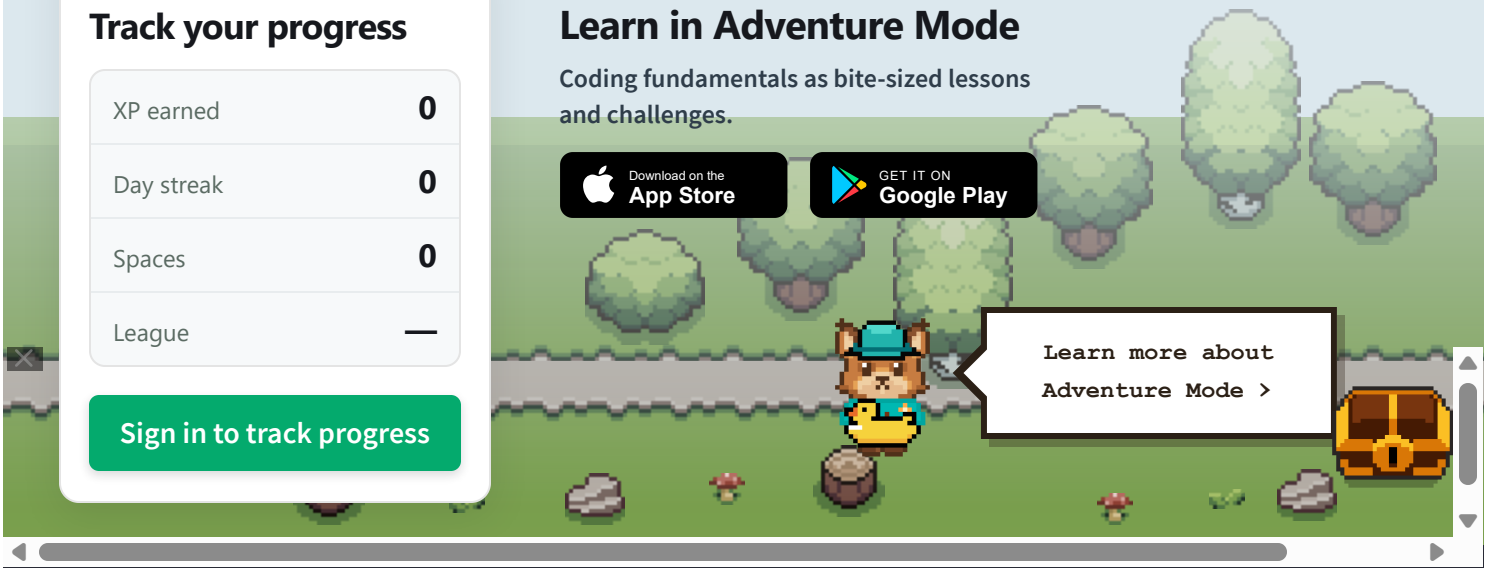
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